



SPR Customer Procedure: FTP Implementation

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OVERVIEW

Standard File Transfer Protocol (FTP) can be used by Direct EDI customers to transfer files to and retrieve files from S. P. Richards (SPR) over the Internet. Since no software installation is involved, the setup is extremely fast and easy. Initially, all testing is performed using the FTP test account. Then, after the testing phase is complete, the assigned production account is used.

Before beginning this procedure, call SPR Customer Support and obtain your unique FTP account and password which will be assigned by the SPR EDI Team. **Anonymous FTP is not allowed.** The account name for the general test account is “ftptest” and the password can be obtained by contacting SPR Customer Support. Periodically, the general ftptest test account password will be changed, but the latest password can always be obtained from SPR Customer Support.

PROCEDURE

1. Call SPR Customer Support and request an FTP EDI setup. This step gets the Dealer’s request into the SPR system and assigns it a ticket number.
2. Obtain a login and password from the SPR EDI Group.
3. Verify the URL connection to the SPR FTP server.
 - The address of the FTP server at SPR is **ftp.sprich.com**.
 - This server has FTP test and production capabilities.
4. Verify that a test file can be placed in and retrieved from the assigned mailbox. Each FTP account will have a secure mailbox, and after each login the Dealer will be located in their assigned mailbox. This mailbox will have an “in” subdirectory and an “out” subdirectory. Files sent to SPR must be placed in the “in” subdirectory. Files to be retrieved are found in the “out” subdirectory. Of course, any FTP application can be used to send and retrieve files, and customers can login to check their mailbox as often as required. However, more than one FTP connection in a 15 second period will not be allowed.
5. The following steps are recommended for an FTP EDI communications session.
 - a) Log in to the SPR FTP server.
 - b) Put incoming files in the “in” subdirectory. These files will be automatically processed. When a file is initially place in the “in” directory, the file name should be prefixed with “tmp.” After the file has been transferred the file should be renamed so that the prefix is removed.
 - c) Get outgoing files from the “out” subdirectory.
 - d) Delete all successfully retrieved files from the “out” subdirectory.
 - e) Logout.



6. Verify that SPR's automated FTP EDI is working. Send a test file to SPR and then retrieve the automatic response. First, at the remote computer create a file named *ftpctest.date.xxxxxxxxxxxx*, where *date* is the current date formatted as *052301*, *xxxxxxxxxxx* is a random series of digits and the content of the file is just "test". Change to the directory or folder that contains the test file. Login to the FTP server using the test account *ftpctest* and password obtained from SPR Customer Support. FTP the file to the "in" subdirectory. Wait five seconds, and then get the acknowledgement from the "out" subdirectory.
7. Delete the acknowledgement from the "out" subdirectory. If at any time an error is encountered, discontinue the procedure and contact SPR Customer Support for assistance.

The following list of commands is a sample session that can be performed from a UNIX or DOS prompt. The file names below are constructed with "mmddyy" as the date, "passwd" as the password and "xxxxxxxxxxx" as a unique identifier. Substitute a random series of 12 digits for the "xxxxxxxxxxx" and the actual date for "mmddyy".

- a) `ftp -n -v ftp.sprich.com`
- b) `ftp> user ftpctest passwd`
- c) `ftp> cd in`
- d) `ftp> put tmp.ftpctest.mmddyy.xxxxxxxxxxxx`
- e) `ftp> rename tmp.ftpctest.mmddyy.xxxxxxxxxxxx ftpctest.mmddyy.xxxxxxxxxxxx`
- f) `ftp> cd ../out`
- g) `ftp> get ftpctest.mmddyy.xxxxxxxxxxxx.er`
- h) `ftp> delete ftpctest.mmddyy.xxxxxxxxxxxx.er`
- i) `ftp> exit`

At this point, the response file should be on the customer's computer. Since the file sent to SPR does not contain a valid order, an error file will be created as an acknowledgement. The acknowledgement file should have on its first line the phrase "ERROR: H0 record missing." The rest of the file should be exactly as the original file sent to SPR. Note that if the file had not had an error, the ".er" suffix would not be in the file name.

This FTP test can be performed at any time to verify that the remote computer can establish FTP communications with SPR. However, it only needs to be performed when a customer account is first setup.



8. Since each customer has an individual production mailbox, at each login to the SPR FTP Server for production purposes, the customer's assigned account and password must be used. Any files to be delivered to SPR should be placed in the mailbox "in" subdirectory. SPR places all files to be returned to the customer in the mailbox "out" subdirectory. After a file is retrieved from the "out" subdirectory, that file must be deleted. SPR recommends that the "out" subdirectory be checked and cleaned at each login. Any file left in the "out" subdirectory of a mailbox for more than seven days will be automatically deleted.

The following list of commands is a sample production EDI session that can be performed from a UNIX or DOS prompt. If at any time an error message is encountered, discontinue the procedure and contact SPR Customer Support for assistance. In the following list of commands "cust" is used for the customer's account and "passwd" is used as the password. Substitute the assigned production account and password as required.

- a) ftp -n -v -i ftp.sprich.com
- b) ftp> user cust password
- c) ftp> cd in
- d) ftp> mput tmp.cust.*
- e) ftp> rename tmp.cust.052301.po876 cust.052301.po876
- f) ftp> rename tmp.cust.052301.po877 cust.052301.po877
- g) ftp> rename tmp.cust.052301.po878 cust.052301.po878
- h) ftp> cd ../out
- i) ftp> mget cust.*
- j) ftp> mdelete cust.*
- k) ftp> exit

9. Standard FTP supports scripting. The "-s:" option can be used to specify a script. For example if the above FTP commands are put into a file named "spr.ftpscript.txt", then the script can be executed with the following FTP command.

ftp -s:spr.ftpscript.txt

10. Production files sent to SPR must be formatted according to SPR documentation for the particular type of file.

All file names must start with the customers assigned account prefix followed by a ".", then the date, formatted as 052301, followed by a ".", then the PO number for the order, or any unique series of characters. Files names returned from SPR will have the same file name with a possible suffix added. All documentation can be obtained by contacting SPR Customer Support. A sample file name could be "myname.052301.187744". All files names sent to SPR must be unique.

11. Except for scheduled maintenance every Sunday morning, the FTP Server at SPR is available 24 hours day, seven days a week. Customers will be notified prior to any scheduled maintenance.



CONTACTS

SPR Customer Support 888-763-2615 770-803-4457 helpdesk@sprich.com

REFERENCES

1. SPRCP-00103 *SPR Distribution Centers*

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